

Could the state take over juvenile halls?

Atty. Gen. Bonta considers stripping county control of L.A.'s chaotic facilities amid calls for reform.

By James Queally

It should have been a normal day at school, or as normal as a classroom setting is in juvenile detention.

But lessons at Los Padri-nos Juvenile Hall were inter-rupted on a Friday in early April when three teenagers suffered what county officials later confirmed were drug overdoses. One col-lapsed in front of his class-mates and two others passed out in their rooms, according to multiple sources who requested anony-mity to discuss the on-go-ing investigation.

The L.A. County Probation Department, which oversees Los Padrinos, said three youths were hospital-ized on April 10 because of overdoses from an unspeci-fied drug. The day before, the sources familiar with the investigation said, proba-tion officers found a large quantity of Xanax inside the Downey facility, where most of the approximately 270 de-tainees are 18 or younger.

The emergency was the latest in a years-long series of fiascoes within L.A. Coun-ty's juvenile halls — all of which have unfolded under the watchful eye of the Cali-fornia attorney general's of-fice.

Four years after the state's Department of Jus-tice entered into a settle-ment to improve conditions in L.A. County's juvenile halls, frustrations are hit-ting a boiling point. The Probation Department has shown no signs of progress, prompting calls for Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta to inter-vene.

Bonta declined an inter-view request but said in a written statement to The Times that the Probation Department is headed toward the “end of the line.”

Bonta said he is prepar-ing “to take steps” to ask a court to place the Probation Department in receivership, essentially wrestling control of the agency from the lead-ers who have failed to imple-ment reforms.

“The current situation at Los Angeles County juvenile halls — and particularly at Los Padrinos — is unaccept-able,” Bonta said. “Los An-geles County continues to fail to implement the court-ordered reforms necessary to protect the health, safety, and well-being of the kids under their care.”

Already shut down once, Los Padrinos was reopened [See Juvenile halls, A8]



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

ANIMAL SHELTERS SPARED

L.A. Mayor Karen Bass says the city's shelters will avoid closures once \$5 million that was set aside in the budget is moved to Animal Services. Above, a dog at a city shelter in South L.A. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

L.A. test program aims to halt homelessness before it starts

By Doug Smith

When the unknown num-ber popped up on her phone, Jocelyn Escanuela was in the checkout line at Wal-mart. She still can't explain why she picked up and then listened to a cold-caller's pitch that sounded a lot like

a scam.

She had been selected to receive a grant of \$6,000, the caller told her. And she would have a personal as-sistant to help her get her through her “crisis.”

How did they even know she was in a crisis?

It turned out the caller was legitimate. She was

from the Homelessness Pre-vention Unit, an experimen-tal Los Angeles County pro-gram that is testing whether it is feasible to stop home-lessness before it starts — one person at a time — by picking them out of moun-tains of data.

Escanuela's crisis was de-tected not by a person but a

predictive statistical model that was developed to solve a conundrum that has made homelessness prevention a tantalizing but underused strategy.

Despite sound evidence that services such as evic-tion defense and financial assistance can prevent peo- [See Trial, A5]

COLUMN ONE

Like, subscribe and pray along

Formerly Hollywood hopefuls, the hosts of ‘Girls Gone Bible’ have gained a young, faithful following online

By Deborah Netburn

Angela Halili was having a rough day. But that did not keep the former actor from arriving to her weekly meeting with her best friend, Arielle Reitsma, also a former actor and model, in a West Hollywood recording studio.

Nearly every week for the past two years, the two have convened there to share heart-to-hearts that are at the core of “Girls Gone Bible,” an evangelical podcast with millions of listeners. And this week, Halili's personal struggles were in focus.

“You want to talk about your heart a little bit?” Reitsma asked Halili. Halili nodded.

“It's just like, growth is so uncom-fortable,” she said, holding back tears. “Transition is so uncomfort-able. And someone stole my Erewhon delivery today.”

Reitsma and Halili, both honey blonds with impeccable makeup, [See ‘Girls,’ A12]



JULIANA YAMADA Los Angeles Times

ANGELA HALILI, left, and Arielle Reitsma host the popular evan-gelical podcast “Girls Gone Bible” out of a West Hollywood studio.

Faceoff looms on rules for cleaner vehicles

California's authority to enforce its own, stricter standards is targeted in a series of GOP-led House votes.

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — The U.S. House took a trio of votes this week targeting California's decades-old au-thority to enforce its own en-vironmental standards, set-ting the stage for a faceoff in the Senate, where Demo-crats say GOP leaders would have to defy long-standing protocol to get the measures passed.

The votes called into question California's waiver from the Clean Air Act of 1970, an authority that has allowed the state to set stricter pollution guidelines and empowered its leaders to set an alternative stand-ard on car emissions to those of the federal govern-ment.

On Thursday, Republi-cans in the House, joined by a handful of Democrats, voted to prohibit California from banning the sale of new gasoline-only cars by 2035. The day before, the House voted along similar lines to end California's ability to set emissions standards for heavy-duty trucks and to combat smog levels in the state.

For decades, automakers have bent their car produc-tion lines to meet California mileage standards, in part due to the size of the Califor-nia market and in part be-cause the industry has found it a safer bet — with changes in power so com-mon in Washington — to be more stringent on fuel effi-ciency standards than the alternative. Today, more than a dozen states follow California's standards, in-cluding New York, Colorado, Massachusetts, Washington and Oregon.

But since President Trump took office, the Envi-ronmental Protection Agency has questioned whether that authority amounts to a technical “rule” that allows for the Senate to disapprove of the waiver with a simple major-ity vote, under the Congres-sional Review Act.

Trump campaigned on a promise to reverse govern-ment programs promoting the sale of electric vehicles — often derided by critics as “EV mandates” — advocated by then-President Biden and the California government, which aims to phase out the sale of new gasoline-only vehicles by 2035 with its latest program, Advanced Clean Cars II.

Over the last two [See Clean air, A5]

Voices **BILL PLASCHKE** COLUMNIST

Lakers' elimination comes with a ray of hope

Despite demoralizing playoff exit, title run for L.A. is not too far away

Once again, ex-citement be-came embar-rassment.

Once again, a promise was broken.

Once again, the Lakers weren't fast enough or skilled enough or deep enough or strong enough.

Once again, blowing up in the first round of the playoffs for the third time in five years, the Lakers just weren't good enough.

But it's rarely felt this bad.

Rarely has Crypto.com Arena been as quiet during a playoff game as it was

Wednesday in the final minute of a 103-96 loss to the Minnesota Timberwolves.

With 39 seconds left, fans silently filled the aisles and literally turned their back on their beloved Lakers, who historically dropped this series four games to one.

Historically, because it was the first time the Lakers lost a first-round series as a No. 3 or higher seed.

No, they never folded this dramatically.

“Disappointment,” LeBron James said. “Unful-fillment.”

[See Plaschke, A10]

Waltz out as national security advisor

Trump taps him for U.N. ambassador as Secretary of State Rubio takes on duties in interim. **NATION, A4**

Clippers, Kings coverage online

For full coverage of their playoff series matchups, go to the eNewspaper or **latimes.com/sports**.

Weather

Cloudy, then sunny. L.A. Basin: 71/57. **B6**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.

Tony noms are not starstruck

Fresh faces and original ideas lead the way in Broadway's top honors. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

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